

Action Timeline — Now September 2027 Intake

Today: **13 July 2026**. Target enrolment: **September 2027**. Most scholarship/application windows for that intake open **Oct 2026 – Feb 2027**, so the next ~4 months are preparation, and the winter is when you apply.

The two things that unlock everything — do them first

1. **IELTS Academic (or TOEFL iBT)**. You haven't taken it, and *almost every* program above requires it (typical bar: IELTS 6.0–6.5 / TOEFL 79–90). Scores are valid 2 years. **Book now, sit it in September 2026**. That gives you a valid score before the earliest deadlines and a retake buffer.
2. **Portfolio (3–5 works)**. Required by ReSound, DIGICREA, HKU, Sonology, and Türkiye/MIAM. Mix finished tracks/productions, sound-design pieces, and any audio-code projects (your software edge). **Start now; have a v1 by November 2026**.

Month-by-month

July–August 2026 — Prepare

- Book IELTS Academic (target: Sept 2026 sitting). Begin prep.
- Start the portfolio: aim for 3–5 strong pieces; document your role and process.
- Draft a **base CV** and a **base motivation letter** you'll tailor per program (your `apply-cv-builder` and `apply-sop-writer` skills help here).
- **Chevening opens (~early Aug)** — start its essays early; it closes 6 Oct.
- Register interest / accounts on: EACEA Erasmus+ catalogue, DreamApply (Hungary), universityadmissions.se (Sweden), Studielink (Netherlands).

September 2026 — Test + set up

- **Sit IELTS**. (Retake in Oct if needed.)
- Finalize portfolio v1 and your CV.
- Line up **2 referees** (for EMJM, Chevening, IES) and brief them (`apply-recommendation-letter-strategist`).

October 2026 — First wave opens (and one hard deadline)

- ** Chevening deadline: 6 October 2026, 11:00 UTC** — do not miss.
- HKU (NL) applications open **1 Oct**; KTH/Sweden opens **16 Oct**.
- Erasmus Mundus calls begin opening (ReSound, MAGMa ~Oct).

November 2026 — EMJM + Hungary

- **DIGICREA opens (~Nov)** — your top pick; prepare its 3–5 work portfolio + references.
- **Stipendium Hungaricum opens (~mid-Nov)** — start the dual application (DreamApply + Tunisian ministry nomination).
- Submit early where portals allow.

December 2026 — Finland + submit

- Aalto opens ~Dec 1.
- Prepare/submit DAAD (German master + DAAD scholarship).
- Draft all program-specific SOPs.

January 2027 — Peak deadline month

- KTH: 15 Jan 2027.
- Stipendium Hungaricum: ~15 Jan 2027.
- Türkiye Bursları opens 10 Jan (closes 20 Feb).
- ReSound EMJM: ~late Jan.
- Government of Ireland IES: ~Jan–Mar (apply to the Irish master first).
- Chevening interviews for shortlisted candidates.

February 2027 — Close out EMJM/Turkey

- DIGICREA: ~16 Feb.
- Türkiye Bursları closes 20 Feb.
- Aalto/Aalborg finalization.

March 2027 — Last deadlines + secure offers

- Aalborg: 1 March.
- Secure **admission offers** you'll need for conditional scholarships (Chevening, IES require an offer).

April–June 2027 — Results + accept

- NAWA Banach call (~April).
- Scholarship results roll in: EMJM ~Apr–May, IES ~June, Stipendium Hungaricum ~June/July.
- Accept your best offer; decline others promptly.

July–August 2027 — Logistics

- Student visa/residence permit, housing, flights, funds proof.

September 2027 — Enrol

Still open in 2026 (mostly self-pay / Sept-2026 entry — not your target, listed for awareness)

-
- A few EMJM programs (e.g. MAGMa) had **self-funded** international deadlines running into **late July 2026** for the **Sept 2026** cohort — these are *not* funded and not your intake. Your funded route is the Oct 2026–Feb 2027 window above.
 - If you ever wanted to start a year early self-funded, the tuition-free public options (Germany, DIGICREA's zero-tuition, low-fee Italy/France) in the full database are where to look — but the plan above targets **funded, Sept 2027**.

The critical path (don't let these slip)

1. **IELTS by Sept 2026** — gates everything.
2. **Portfolio v1 by Nov 2026** — gates ReSound, DIGICREA, HKU, Sonology, MIAM.
3. **Chevening 6 Oct 2026** — earliest hard deadline.
4. **Jan–Feb 2027** — the bulk of funded deadlines land here; have SOPs + references ready by December.